

2026 TECHNO 293 WORLD CHAMPIONSHIPS

Foça, Izmir · Türkiye · 5 – 9 April 2026

TEAM INDIA

YAI Report — Performance Debrief

Submitted to the Yachting Association of India

8	4	10	18
ATHLETES	CLASSES	RACES	NATIONS

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Coaching staff	Sh. Prakash (Coach) · Mrs. Meenu Johal (Team Manager)
Sanctioning body	International Windsurfing Association (IWA) / World Sailing
Federation	Yachting Association of India (YAI)
Venue	Mark Warner Phokaia Beach Resort, Foça, Türkiye
Report date	11 April 2026

Event summary · Team performance analysis · Individual athlete analysis · Forward plan

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Submitted to the Yachting Association of India — Confidential

1. EVENT OVERVIEW

The 2026 Techno 293 & Techno 293 Plus World Championships were held at Mark Warner Phokaia Beach Resort, Foça, Izmir, Türkiye from 5 to 9 April 2026. The regatta was sanctioned by the International Windsurfing Association (IWA) and ran fleet racing across seven classes spanning U13 through T293 Plus Open, with a combined entry of 259 athletes from 18 nations. Team India entered eight athletes across four of those classes — U15 Boys, U15 Girls, U17 Boys, and U17 Girls. All subsequent analysis in this report is scoped to the four classes Team India participated in.

EVENT DATES	VENUE	TOTAL BOATS	COUNTRIES	CLASSES
5–9 Apr 2026	Foça, Türkiye	259	18	7 total · 4 India

1.1 Classes and Fleet Size (Full Event)

Class	Age / division	Entries	Team India
T293 U13	U13 · Born 2014–2016	28	—
T293 U15 Boys	U15 Boys · Born 2012–2016	36	2 athletes
T293 U15 Girls	U15 Girls · Born 2012–2016	23	2 athletes
T293 U17 Boys	U17 Boys · Born 2010–2014	52	2 athletes
T293 U17 Girls	U17 Girls · Born 2010–2014	39	2 athletes
T293 Plus Men	Senior open (men)	56	—
T293 Plus Women	Senior open (women)	25	—
TOTAL	7 classes	259	8 athletes (4 classes)

1.2 Medal Table — Team India Classes

Podium positions in the four classes Team India participated in. (T293 U13 and T293 Plus Men / Women class results are not detailed here as they fall outside the scope of this report.)

Class	Gold	Silver	Bronze
U15 Boys	ESP · Joshua Castro-Jurek	FRA · Simon Pirastu	ESP · Marcos Dasilva-González
U15 Girls	ESP · Cristina Iglesias-Rubio	ITA · Chiara Marras	TUR · Derin Toker
U17 Boys	GRE · Orestis-Nikolaos Palamidis	GRE · Spyridon Monastiriotis	GRE · Foivos Koulalis
U17 Girls	EST · Johanna Lukk	GRE · Kyriaki Zerva	ESP · Olivia Sanchez-Moral

Within Team India's four classes, Spain (ESP) and Greece (GRE) took the majority of podium positions, with Estonia, France, Italy, and Türkiye also medalling. India did not medal at this edition — results are analysed in Sections 2 and 3.

1.3 Conditions on the Water

Conditions over the 5 racing days were varied, spanning from light 6 kn sea breezes to strong 18 kn gradient winds, with short X-band (17+ kn) puffs on the opening day. The venue (Foça bay, Aegean coast) delivered typical spring conditions: morning calm, afternoon thermal build-up, and occasional strong frontal activity.

WIND MEAN	WIND RANGE	PEAK GUST	AIR TEMP*	WATER TEMP*	PRECIP
10.6 kn	6–18 kn	22 kn	12–19 °C	~16 °C	None

* Air / water temperature values are April climate reference for the Foça–İzmir coast (Aegean) and match the range observed on the water. All 5 racing days were dry with no precipitation affecting the schedule.

Wind band distribution (10 race slots):

Band	Range	Slots	% of event	T293 setup profile
A	≤ 5 kn	0	0%	Float / drift — light-air technique
B	6–8 kn	4	40%	Light planing threshold — pump & glide
C	9–12 kn	2	20%	Sub-max power — fin & heel control
D	13–16 kn	3	30%	Overpowered — strap/harness, flat board
X	17+ kn	1	10%	Survival — back-hand, depower, straight lines

Day-by-day condition log:

Day	Date	Races	Bands	Wind	Notes
D1	2026-04-05	3	D · X · D	14–18 kn	Strong / variable — survival X-band in middle race
D2	2026-04-06	3	B · B · B	6–7 kn	Light sea breeze — technical pump conditions
D3	2026-04-07	0	A	< 5 kn	Racing cancelled — insufficient wind (A-band, < 5 kn all day)
D4	2026-04-08	1	B	6–6 kn	Light sea breeze — single race completed
D5	2026-04-09	3	C · C · D	10–14 kn	Building breeze — last race gusted D-band

2. TEAM RESULTS & OVERALL ANALYSIS

2.1 Final Standings — Team India

Athlete	Sail #	Class	Rank	Fleet	Nett pts	Best race	Races scored
Udaiveer Johal	IND01	U15 Boys	23	36	187	12	10 / 10
Vihaan Prakash	IND07	U15 Boys	36	36	316	31	6 / 10
Vaishnavi Kajale	IND02	U15 Girls	18	23	142	8	8 / 10
Priyanshi Patil	IND11	U15 Girls	20	23	159	14	10 / 10
Mohit Mhatre	IND16	U17 Boys	41	52	345	17	10 / 10
Rajput Yogesh	IND261	U17 Boys	46	52	371	34	10 / 10
Tejasvi Prajapati	IND39	U17 Girls	35	39	320	31	6 / 10
Rashmita Thimiti	IND18	U17 Girls	36	39	323	28	6 / 10

2.2 Performance by Wind Band

The most revealing lens on team performance is the wind band analysis. Each race is classified into one of the five T293 wind bands (A–X) and Team India’s average VMC score (a composite of upwind and downwind performance versus the class Top 5) is computed per band. This exposes which conditions the team is genuinely competitive in, and which ones require systematic training.

Band	Condition	Races	Team vs Top 5	Status	Tech / Physical priority
A	≤ 5 kn	0	—	NO DATA — No A-band races sailed	—
B	6–8 kn	16	81.8%	STRENGTH — Competitive — approaching top-5 speed	Tech — · Phys #1
C	9–12 kn	8	66.6%	CORE GAP — Fundamentals gap — highest long-term leverage	Tech #1 · Phys #2
D	13–16 kn	12	66.0%	GAP — Control & endurance under load	Tech #2 · Phys #3
X	17+ kn	4	76.7%	DEVELOPING — Confidence in survival conditions	Tech #3 · Phys #4

Training priority framework. Technical priority (C > D > X) reflects the fundamentals-first philosophy: Band C (9–12 kn) is the condition in which acceleration, pumping technique, board control, and fast trimming are most trainable, and the long-term performance ceiling of each athlete is set by their C-band completeness. D and X gaps are closed on top of a solid C-band base. Physical conditioning priority (B > C > D > X) reflects pumping stamina as the dominant physiological load in T293 racing, which peaks in light (B) and medium (C) conditions.

2.3 Confirmed Strength and Development Areas

CONFIRMED STRENGTH

Light-wind (B-band) competitiveness — 81.8% of Top 5.

In 6–8 kn conditions the team posts its best result of the championship. Three athletes (Vaishnavi, Udaiveer, Mohit) break the 86% threshold of Top-5 speed, putting them in genuine top-10 range within the class.

This is the only wind band in which the squad, as a group, is competitive with the international front of fleet, and it reflects the relatively high volume of light-air training the Indian programme currently supports.

Scope note: no other area of the 2026 Foça regatta data supports a group-level strength claim at the required 75% of Top-5 threshold. C, D and X bands are all reported as development areas on the right, and individual peaks (e.g. a single X-band race above 100%) are treated as athlete-level observations in Section 3, not team properties.

DEVELOPMENT AREAS

1. Medium-breeze (C-band) dropoff — 66.6% of Top 5.

The largest performance gap, and the single most load-bearing diagnosis in this report. 9–12 kn is the most common T293 championship condition globally, and the team loses ~15 percentage points versus light-wind form. Root causes are all technique / board-handling, not tactical: (i) C-band pumping technique — basic cycle timing and the explosive pump-for-acceleration both underdeveloped; (ii) daggerboard-track transition agility — slow and inconsistent up/down cycles through gusts and mark roundings; (iii) fast trim response under changing pressure — late retrim when the wind shifts or puffs in.

2. Strong-wind (D-band) speed and control — 66.0% of Top 5.

Speed holds up for 3–4 legs but drops progressively by the final downwind. Gap is strongest for the U17 girls and U15 Vihaan. Both technique and physical capacity are contributors, but technique is the primary limiter: control under load, stance, fore-aft trim, and rig handling let the athlete spend physical capacity efficiently. Physical conditioning remains a necessary supporting block, not the standalone answer.

3. Start-line execution — first 90 seconds, physical not tactical.

Squad mean fleet position at Mark 1 is in the deep percentile range (12.7%, with 7 of 8 athletes at ★0.5 on Mark-1 percentile). Importantly, the side choice is not the problem: squad average agreement with the Top-5 favoured side is 88% — every athlete logs ★5.0 on C1 side agreement. The deficit is established in the first 90 seconds after the gun: explosive pumping volume, acceleration off the line, and ability to hold a space on the line are all underdeveloped. Only 1 of 8 athletes (Udaiveer) ever rounded a windward mark in the top half of the fleet. This is a physical-technique issue — the coachable fix is pumping-for-acceleration drilling, not tactical side coaching.

4. Sample-size asymmetry across the squad.

Three athletes — Vihaan (U15B), Tejasvi and Rashmita (U17G) — each sailed only 6 scoring races on a 10-race card due to R1–R3 DNCs. The combined R1–R3 DNC burden cost ~15 points for Vihaan alone and another ~12 points across the two U17 girls — directly worsening three of the squad's eight final positions. Future world campaigns must eliminate opening-day entry gaps as a non-negotiable pre-requirement.

2.4 Detailed Performance Table — All Athletes

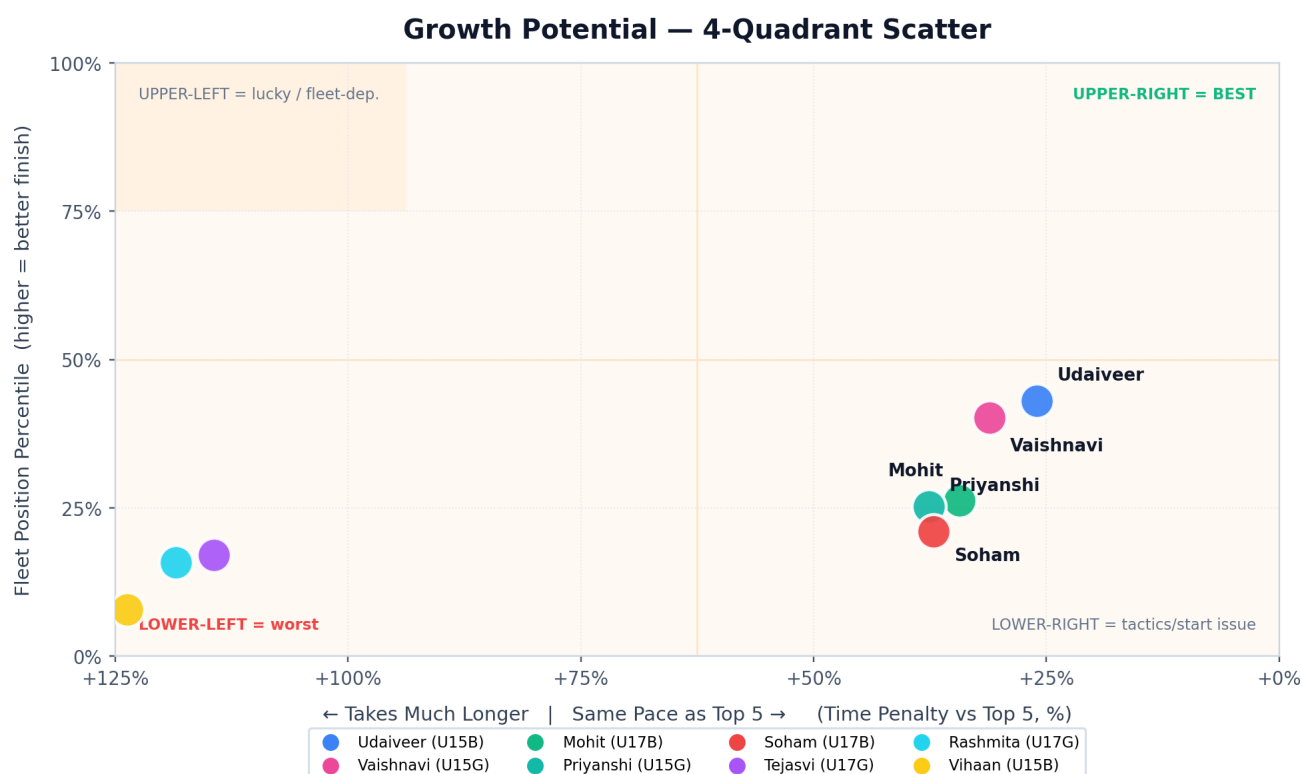
Per-athlete GPS metrics (race-aggregate mean ± SD across all scored races) versus the class Top-5 reference, expressed as gap %. Sorted by composite VMG/VMC gap (UW and DW, up- and down-course combined) — this is the VMG-primary view that isolates sailing effectiveness from raw boat speed.

TIER LEGEND		GOLD ≥ -5%	EMERALD ≥ -15%	SKY ≥ -25%	AMBER ≥ -35%	ORANGE ≥ -50%	RED < -50%
Athlete	Class	Composite (gap %)	Avg Speed (kn)	UW VMG (kn)	UW VMC (kn)	DW VMG (kn)	DW VMC (kn)
Udaiveer Johal	U15 Boys	-20.3%	9.23±3.74 (-8.2%)	2.78±0.60 (-18.4%)	2.66±0.52 (-20.0%)	5.57±1.79 (-20.3%)	5.34±1.65 (-22.7%)
Rajput Yogesh	U17 Boys	-20.9%	9.98±4.99 (-7.4%)	2.87±0.85 (-21.1%)	2.50±0.60 (-30.5%)	6.37±2.40 (-15.6%)	6.11±2.11 (-16.5%)
Vaishnavi Kajale	U15 Girls	-21.7%	7.72±3.43 (-15.8%)	2.66±0.58 (-19.9%)	2.49±0.53 (-22.3%)	4.90±1.54 (-22.4%)	4.83±1.42 (-22.3%)
Mohit Mhatre	U17 Boys	-23.4%	9.29±4.32 (-13.9%)	2.84±0.73 (-21.9%)	2.67±0.70 (-25.8%)	5.81±2.12 (-22.9%)	5.63±1.80 (-23.1%)
Priyanshi Patil	U15 Girls	-24.6%	7.82±2.88 (-14.7%)	2.54±0.62 (-23.3%)	2.20±0.57 (-31.4%)	4.93±1.22 (-21.8%)	4.87±1.10 (-21.7%)
Rashmita Thimiti	U17 Girls	-45.6%	4.56±1.10 (-51.6%)	1.91±0.25 (-61.2%)	1.82±0.22 (-62.6%)	3.73±0.59 (-29.0%)	3.60±0.44 (-29.5%)
Tejasvi Prajapati	U17 Girls	-46.3%	4.69±1.31 (-50.3%)	2.08±0.46 (-57.8%)	1.97±0.44 (-59.6%)	3.50±0.52 (-33.4%)	3.35±0.46 (-34.5%)
Vihaan Prakash	U15 Boys	-48.0%	5.10±1.21 (-49.2%)	2.00±0.46 (-41.3%)	1.78±0.35 (-46.4%)	3.43±0.54 (-51.0%)	3.23±0.59 (-53.2%)

COACHING INSIGHT. Composite VMG/VMC gap ranks the squad very differently from final finish position — that divergence is the whole point of this view. **Soham** sits mid-pack on composite (≈ -21%) yet finishes 46/52: his weakness is NOT sailing effectiveness, it is race execution (start line + first 90 seconds). **Mohit** has a slightly weaker composite than Soham but converts it into rank 41/52 via one tactical breakthrough race. **Vihaan, Tejasvi, Rashmita** land in orange/red territory — their composite is a supporting signal for the domestic skills-rebuild recommendation in §3. Gold/emerald tiers mean the sailing toolkit is already international; red/orange mean the toolkit itself must be rebuilt before results work.

2.5 Growth Potential — 4-Quadrant Scatter

X = Time Penalty vs Top 5 (%) — how much longer it takes this athlete to cover the same course, combining speed AND route efficiency. 0% = identical to Top 5 pace; +100% means they take double the time. Y = Fleet Position Percentile. **Upper-right = best.**



HOW TO READ. X is the true performance gap — a slow sailor on a straight line is still slow. Right side = pace matches Top 5 (good); upper = finish positions near the top of the fleet. Athletes in the upper-right corner are closest to Top-5 performance. Far-left points are $>2\times$ slower than Top 5 over the same course. **Udaiveer, Vaishnavi, Mohit, Priyanshi, Soham** cluster in the middle-lower band (competitive pace, mid-low finishes — a conversion problem, closable inside 1 training cycle). **Tejasvi, Rashmita, Vihaan** sit far-left (foundational skill gap — domestic rebuild priority as detailed in §3).

3. INDIVIDUAL ATHLETE ANALYSIS

The eight athletes are grouped by class. Each profile gives the final rank, the best single-race finish, and a concise strength/weakness statement grounded in the GPS and race-score data. Recommendations are practical, athlete-specific and season-targeted.

3.1 U15 Boys

Udaiveer Johal

U15 Boys · Sail IND01 · Rank 23/36 · Best race: 12

Band snapshot: Best in Band B (86% of Top 5) · Weakest in Band D (72%)

Strengths: Best India result of the championship — rank 23/36, best race 12th. Data-supported multi-band speed: B-band 86.7%, C-band 80.4%, X-band 75.5% of Top 5 — three bands above the 75% competitive threshold, the only Indian athlete with this profile. C-band 80.4% is the highest on the squad. *Coach observations supporting the numbers:* board speed in planing conditions is visibly strong; stance and body position hold up extremely well even in survival (X-band) conditions; a clear natural feel for the board; strong appetite for results and a high learning willingness, which is the most valuable coachability trait in the squad.

Weaknesses: D-band drops to 72.7% of Top 5 — just below threshold. Start-line acceleration is the single largest gap: acceleration off the line is late, and he does not yet know how to pump for acceleration — the aggressive early-start pumping volume that separates the top fleet from the mid-fleet is missing. After the start he struggles to hold a good wind lane and loses focus on his own board — eyes off his equipment and onto the fleet, a confidence rather than technical issue. Downwind laylines to the leeward mark are consistently too long (sails too wide), and at mark roundings he repeatedly gives up the inside lane — probably because board control and rules confidence in close quarters are still developing. Positioning on the line is improving, but space creation for acceleration and raw acceleration ability remain the limiting factor.

Priority focus: Start-line acceleration pumping (drill priority #1), leeward-mark layline judgment, and close-quarters mark-rounding confidence (board control + rules). Fixing the start and first 30 seconds alone would move his Mark 1 average into the top third of the fleet — with his speed profile, a top-15 European Championship result is realistic inside one focused training cycle.

Vihaan Prakash

U15 Boys · Sail IND07 · Rank 36/36 · Best race: 31

Band snapshot: Best in Band B (69% of Top 5) · Weakest in Band C (44%)

Strengths: No sailing-specific strength at this event. Rank 36/36, band speed B 69.1%, C 44.3% of Top 5 — both well below the 75% competitive threshold. *Coach observation — non-sailing asset:* Vihaan is clearly intelligent and has a sharp sense for situations, which is a genuine long-term coachability trait. However, this is a personality asset, not a sailing strength, and must not be confused with one in a performance report.

Weaknesses: Both physically and in raw sailing skill the athlete is currently shrinking rather than developing — the 2026 Foça championship may have actively worked against him. The technical gap (basic planing, pumping, board handling) is wide enough that he is not yet at a level where international fleet racing produces useful learning; each race at this level is more likely to reinforce avoidance and low self-efficacy than to build skill. R1–R3 DNC gap cost approximately 15 points.

Priority focus: Priority is rebuilding the fundamentals in a protected domestic environment, not more international exposure. Continued repeated placement at international championships in his current state carries a real risk of cementing negative self-concept long-term. Recommendation: a 12–18 month domestic skills rebuild (fitness, planing control, pumping, start handling) with process goals only — no international results targets — and re-evaluation before any next world-level entry.

3.2 U15 Girls

Vaishnavi Kajale

U15 Girls · Sail IND02 · Rank 18/23 · Best race: 8

Band snapshot: Best in Band B (88% of Top 5) · Weakest in Band D (73%)

Strengths: Rank 18/23, best race 8th — only Indian athlete to break into top 10 in a single race. Two-band data-supported strength: B-band 88.6% and C-band 82.4% of Top 5, both well above the 75% competitive threshold. C-band 82.4% is the second-highest on the squad. *Coach observation — a third genuine asset:* visible confidence in light-wind (B-band) conditions. This on-water self-efficacy is itself a strength and explains much of her B-band performance; it is also the foundation on which her C-band work has been built.

Weaknesses: Raw muscle power and strong pumping-for-acceleration are clearly underdeveloped — she does not yet have the explosive pump the top-10 girls use to punch off the line and hold a lane. Start-line execution suffers: she struggles to hold her position on the line and to create the space she needs for an acceleration window. Sail trim fine-tuning and fast daggerboard-track transitions (up and down) are not yet automatic. Start-line rules knowledge also needs dedicated study — several situations at Foça were lost on rules understanding rather than boat handling. D-band drops to 73.4% of Top 5.

Priority focus: Priority drills: (1) strength & explosive pumping block targeting the acceleration window; (2) start-line space-holding and rules study — Racing Rules Parts 2 and Appendix LP; (3) daggerboard-track transition speed (fast up/down cycles as a standalone technical drill); (4) live trim adjustment under changing pressure. Podium potential at the next European championship is realistic with one focused cycle on these specific gaps.

Priyanshi Patil

U15 Girls · Sail IND11 · Rank 20/23 · Best race: 14

Band snapshot: Best in Band B (84% of Top 5) · Weakest in Band D (67%)

Strengths: B-band speed — 84.1% of Top 5. In 6–8 kn conditions she is competitive at class level. This is her only band where performance clears the 75% competitive threshold — C, D and X all sit in the 67–73% range, so on the sailing-skill side the supported strength list is narrow. *Coach observation — attitude asset:* she shows a clearly strong appetite for results. When things do not go her way she visibly and openly expresses frustration — which, read correctly, is the outward signal of an athlete who wants it. That competitive hunger is a real long-term coaching asset and is the reason the fundamentals work below is worth investing in.

Weaknesses: Pumping technique at a fundamental level — the basic pump cycle and the explosive pump needed for acceleration are both under-developed. Start-line execution is the other big gap: holding a position on the line, creating the space needed to bear off, and accelerating off the gun are all below class standard. C and D speed drops to 67.0–72.8% of Top 5 and B-band 84.1% fades noticeably when overpowered.

Priority focus: Fundamentals-first block: (1) basic pumping technique rebuild (cycle timing and body mechanics before adding power); (2) explosive pumping-for-acceleration drilling; (3) start-line space-holding and acceleration drill (same module as Vaishnavi — pair them in training). Channel the expressed frustration into structured drill intensity rather than treating it as a mood issue; her ambition is the engine that makes this plan work.

3.3 U17 Boys

Mohit Mhatre

U17 Boys · Sail IND16 • Rank 41/52 • Best race: 17

Band snapshot: Best in Band B (87% of Top 5) · Weakest in Band D (66%)

Strengths: Rank 41/52, best race 17th — a significant single-race highlight. Two-band data-supported strength: B-band 87.3% and X-band 78.6% of Top 5, both above the 75% competitive threshold. C-band at 76.7% is borderline and logged as a watch item rather than a strength claim. *Coach observations supporting the numbers:* Mohit is clearly intelligent, with strong personal drive and good on-water sense. More specifically — his **start-line position finding** and initial position-taking are visibly very good, often among the best in the squad. The question is not whether he can read and pick a spot on the line; he can.

Weaknesses: The gap opens in the seconds immediately after picking the spot: **holding** the position, **creating acceleration space**, and **accelerating powerfully off the line** are all underdeveloped, which is why his Mark 1 average sits at 39 despite good initial positioning. Daggerboard track transitions are still immature — this directly limits his ability to convert the start acceleration window into first-beat speed. D-band drops sharply to 66.1% of Top 5 — his weakest condition.

Priority focus: Upwind pumping interval drilling is the primary intervention for the start-acceleration problem — it builds the short-burst power profile needed to convert his already-good line position into actual separation from neighbours. Paired with daggerboard-track transition drills (fast up/down cycles as a standalone technical block) and space-holding practice in mid-line start scenarios. With Mohit's intelligence and drive these are fast-return interventions: moving his Mark 1 average from 39th to 25th would immediately yield a top-30 final rank.

Rajput Yogesh

U17 Boys · Sail IND261 • Rank 46/52 • Best race: 34

Band snapshot: Best in Band B (83% of Top 5) · Weakest in Band D (68%)

Strengths: (Sailwave name: Rajput Yogesh). **Multi-band speed** — B-band 83.1%, C-band 78.0%, X-band 83.5% of Top 5 — three bands above the 75% competitive threshold. His speed profile is genuinely the broadest of the U17 boys on the squad; the low final ranking is therefore **a conversion problem (tactics and start)** rather than a speed problem. *Coach observations supporting the numbers:* he visibly enjoys heavy breeze and is not afraid of speed — this temperamental asset is the foundation of his X-band 83.5% result and is rare in the squad. In medium breeze (C-band) his basic pumping technique is already in place and his raw power is clearly above average, which explains the data. This is a **high-ceiling athlete profile**: with disciplined teaching of fundamental principles he can become a genuinely competitive international racer.

Weaknesses: D-band drops to 68.6% of Top 5 — his only sub-threshold band. Average position at Mark 1 is 44.7th — deepest in the U17 boys fleet. The core gap is **trim response under changing pressure**: when the wind shifts or puffs in, he is slow to retrim and loses the speed advantage that his raw power otherwise gives him. His overall **course-reading ability** (shift recognition, pressure reading, layline judgement) is also still below the level his speed deserves — much of the damage to his final rank (46/52) is done before the first windward mark. A clear theoretical knowledge gap underlies both weaknesses.

Priority focus: Theory-first coaching block is the single highest-leverage intervention for Soham: structured study of wind reading, shift dynamics, layline calculation, and live trim adjustment, paired with on-water drills that repeatedly force fast retrim under changing pressure. Combine with start-line and first-beat tactical drill. Physical profile is already suited to senior class — a Techno 293 Plus step-up should be evaluated for 2027 based on growth.

3.4 U17 Girls

Tejasvi Prajapati

U17 Girls · Sail IND39 · Rank 35/39 · Best race: 31

Band snapshot: Best in Band B (76% of Top 5) · Weakest in Band C (50%)

Strengths: No sailing-result strength at this event. 6 scoring races on a 10-race card is an insufficient sample for a data-supported strength claim, and the band speeds logged sit below the 75% threshold. *Coach observation — physical asset:* she has visibly good raw strength and a bodyweight on the heavier end of the U17 girls fleet. On paper this is exactly the physical profile that should dominate strong-wind (D and X band) racing in Techno 293. That physical asset is the reason there is a realistic ceiling to aim for — but it is currently latent, not active.

Weaknesses: The physical asset is not yet translating into speed because **basic board handling** is almost entirely undeveloped. Right now the bodyweight reads as heavy rather than powerful: stance, trim, fore-aft balance, daggerboard cycles and rig handling all need to be built from foundation level before her strength can convert into board speed. The performance gap is **a sailing-time gap** — she simply has not spent enough hours on the board for automation of the basic movements. Band performance the weakest on C-band (50.4% of Top 5, from a single-race sample). Entry gap and limited event experience compound the skill base problem.

Priority focus: Sailing volume first, detail trim second. The single largest lever is raw water-time — double the on-water hours in the next 12 months before any tactical or event-volume investment pays back. Dedicated detailed trim training (live rig tension, downhaul, daggerboard cycles, fore-aft trim under changing pressure) should be a structured weekly block, not an incidental topic. Ranking goals are deferred — this is a foundation-rebuild year. Once basic board handling is automatic, her strength-plus-bodyweight profile becomes a genuine D/X band weapon.

Rashmita Thimiti

U17 Girls · Sail IND18 · Rank 36/39 · Best race: 28

Band snapshot: Best in Band B (75% of Top 5) · Weakest in Band C (47%)

Strengths: No sailing-specific strength at this event. Band speeds B 75.4%, C 47.7%, D 56.3% of Top 5 — all three bands below the 75% competitive threshold. 6 scoring races after R1–R3 DNCs is an insufficient sample for a strength claim. *Coach observation — physical asset (latent):* her build is similar to Tejasvi's — a heavier-bodied U17G profile that, on paper, should translate into strong-wind advantage. As with Tejasvi this is currently a potential ceiling, not an active competitive asset.

Weaknesses: **The fundamentals are too far below international fleet level for her physical profile to express itself.** Basic board handling, stance, trim, daggerboard cycles, and pumping technique are all well short of the level that would let her convert bodyweight into board speed. The gap is a sailing-time and theory-understanding gap, not a talent gap. R1–R3 DNCs plus 6 valid races on a 10-race card compound the problem — there is no meaningful competitive baseline to benchmark her against.

Priority focus: Foundation rebuild — sailing volume first, land-drill and theory second. Priority is (1) sharply increased on-water hours to automate basic handling; (2) structured land drills (stance, rig handling, daggerboard cycling) as a dedicated weekly block; (3) theory study — rigging, trim principles, pumping mechanics, Racing Rules Parts 2 and Appendix LP. Event targeting should wait until sailing-time and the theoretical base have caught up; campaigning ahead of that baseline burns training capacity without return. Once the fundamentals are in place, the same strong-wind ceiling as Tejasvi becomes a realistic target.

4. FUTURE DIRECTION

Recommendations are organised into three horizons: an immediate 90-day post-championship block, the 2026–2027 competition cycle, and the LA 2028 athletic-pathway view. All numeric targets in this section are locked to the percentile-based Key Success Metrics ladder below — the same ladder used in the Team India Master Debrief Dashboard so that YAI, the coaching staff, and the athletes work off a single set of numbers.

KEY SUCCESS METRICS — PERCENTILE-BASED (fleet-size independent)

Worlds performance is measured as percentile of class fleet (lower = better) so the target does not drift with fleet size. Baseline data below are official Sailwave ranks from 2026 Foça World Championships.

Horizon	Worlds — Best Athlete	Worlds — Team Median	Worlds — Depth (# athletes ≤ target)	Asian Championships
Baseline 2026 Foça (actual result)	Udaiveer 64th %ile (23/36 U15B)	≈ 83rd %ile	0 athletes in Top-30% · 0 in Top-10%	≈ 3rd in Asia (estimated)
Year 1 — 2027	≤ Top 50%	≤ Top 60%	≥ 2 athletes inside Top 40%	4+ athletes Top-10; hold Asian Top-3
Year 2 — 2028	≤ Top 30%	≤ Top 50%	≥ 2 athletes inside Top 25% · ≥ 4 inside Top 40%	Asian Ch. podium (Top-3) in at least 1 class
Year 3 — 2029	≤ Top 20%	≤ Top 40%	≥ 4 athletes inside Top 25%	Asian Ch. Gold in at least 1 class
Year 5 — 2031	≤ Top 10% (podium contender)	≤ Top 30%	≥ 2 athletes inside Top 10% (medal range) · ≥ 6 inside Top 25%	Multi-class Asian Ch. podium; 1+ athlete on senior iQFOiL Olympic-qualification pathway

Top-10% thresholds at 2026 Foça fleet sizes: U15B (36) → Top-4 · U15G (23) → Top-2 · U17B (52) → Top-5 · U17G (39) → Top-4. Youth Olympic Games target removed from plan — the 1-athlete-per-country quota combined with very low participation makes it a low-value benchmark; focus stays on percentile at Worlds + Asian Championships results + senior iQFOiL Olympic pathway.

4.1 Immediate — 90-day Post-Worlds Block (Apr–Jul 2026)

Goal: Close the C-band technique gap and the start-line / first-90-seconds physical gap — the two data-confirmed squad weaknesses — before the next planned Asian championship.

- **Start-line & first-90-seconds drill (#1 leverage).** Daily pumping-for-acceleration block paired with start-line space-holding and explosive-acceleration drills. Squad side-choice is already good (88% agreement with Top 5) — this block does not coach tactics, it coaches the physical act of holding a slot on the line and punching off the gun. Target: move squad Mark-1 percentile from 12.7% into the top third of the fleet.
- **C-band technique block.** Pumping technique rebuild (cycle timing before power), daggerboard-track transition speed as a standalone technical drill (fast up/down cycles), and fast trim response under changing pressure. 80% of on-water time scheduled in 9–12 kn. This block targets the single largest performance gap (C-band 66.6% of Top 5).
- **Wind-band targeted water time.** Light-wind (B-band) training volume is relatively reduced to protect the C/D training window — not eliminated. B-band is currently the squad's only confirmed strength but is still far from international top-5 level (81.8% of Top 5), so B-band training remains part of every week. The 90-day shift is one of proportion, not substitution: C/D gets the larger share of on-water hours, while B-band work continues to preserve and extend the existing strength.
- **Physical conditioning.** Dedicated posterior-chain and core strength block for the U15s and U17 girls. In T293, primary power transfer happens in C-band (9–12 kn) — that is where the pumping, daggerboard-transition, and trim-response technique built in the C-band block above actually converts raw strength into board speed, which is why C-band technique is the #1 training priority. In D-band, physical conditioning and endurance still matter, but technique is the more important limiter: better stance, trim, and control under load let the athlete spend physical capacity efficiently rather than burning it on fighting the rig. Strength work is therefore a supporting block for the on-water technical priorities, not a standalone answer to the D-band gap.
- **Data review cadence.** Weekly coach debrief using the dashboard system built for this championship — preserves analytical continuity.

4.2 2026–2027 Cycle — Asian & European Championships

Goal: The 2027 European Championship entry is already confirmed for July 2026 — the immediate task is to close the data-confirmed squad weaknesses (C-band technique and start-line / first-90-seconds physical gap) in the short window before that event, not to qualify. The year-end Asian Championship is the first ranking-improvement target: the squad aims to better its previous year's Asian result, with every athlete graded against their own 2025 placing rather than against absolute-fleet metrics.

■ **Competition schedule — already fixed.** The 3 international events per year (Asian + European + World) are already confirmed as the annual platform. The 2027 European Championship entry is locked for July 2026 — the squad does not need to qualify; the task is to arrive at that event with the C-band and first-90-seconds gaps closed. Year-end Asian Championship is the first ranking-improvement checkpoint: target is to beat the squad's previous Asian result, athlete-by-athlete.

■ **Lead-tier athletes (Year 1–2 KSM anchors).** Udaiveer (U15B) and Vaishnavi (U15G) are the two athletes the squad is counting on to deliver the Year 1 2027 Worlds target ($\leq$ Top 50% best-athlete, $\geq$ 2 athletes inside Top 40%) and the Year 2 2028 Asian Championships podium (Top-3 in at least 1 class). Resource allocation — international regattas, coaching time, S&C; support — should reflect that role.

■ **Development tier.** Priyanshi, Mohit, Soham held in a structured progression tier: target band Top 40% at Worlds by Year 1 2027, tightening to Top 25% by Year 2 2028 — the same ladder as the Key Success Metrics table in the Section 4 opener.

■ **Foundation tier — split approach.** Tejasvi and Rashmita need maximised on-water training hours before expecting ranking gains. Tejasvi specifically needs basic board-handling automation (stance, trim, daggerboard cycles, rig handling) before international event volume will pay back — her physical profile is latent, not absent. Rashmita is a lower event-count athlete rather than a low-skill one and will benefit from structured championship starts once her training hours are consistent. Vihaan is a different case: his current sailing-skill and physical base are too far below international fleet level for continued world-championship exposure to produce useful learning. Repeated placement at events of this level in his present state carries a risk of cementing a long-term negative self-concept. Recommendation: 12–18 months of protected domestic skills rebuild (fitness, planing control, pumping, start handling) with process-only goals, and re-evaluation before any next world-level entry.

■ **Staff continuity.** The staffing model used at Foça — Head Coach + Support Coach + Team Manager (three-person squad support) — should be retained and formalised. The dedicated Team Manager role is non-optional: it owns logistics, welfare, accommodation, medical, and parent/federation liaison, and frees the coaching staff to work exclusively on performance. Future campaigns should also layer in a dedicated strength & conditioning coach for training blocks where possible, on top of the three-person travelling team.

4.3 LA 2028 Athletic Pathway View

While the Techno 293 is not the Olympic equipment, the squad at Foça represents the pipeline that will feed the Olympic windsurfer class (iQFOiL) and the next India national team. The pathway priorities are:

■ **Class transition planning.** Identify which athletes graduate to Techno 293 Plus in 2027 and which progress directly to iQFOiL development. Decision point by October 2026 based on growth and 2027 Asian results.

■ **International exposure — with a readiness filter.** Minimum 3 international regatta starts per year for athletes whose current skill base allows international racing to produce learning rather than avoidance behaviour. This is the single biggest missing variable for athletes at that readiness level. For athletes still rebuilding fundamentals (see Section 4.2 Foundation tier), international exposure should be deliberately withheld until a domestic skills baseline is re-established, to protect long-term self-concept.

■ **Data-driven coaching continuity.** The analytics system (GPS + wind-band + VMC benchmarking) built for the Foça debrief should become the national windsurfing standard. It turns every regatta into a structured performance learning cycle.

■ **Federation–coach alignment.** Formalise the annual reporting cadence (this document) between Head Coach and YAI. Quarterly progress updates rather than one annual review.

Year 2–5 factual plan (aligned with Team India Master Debrief Dashboard):

Year 2 — Specialization & T293+ Transition (2027-07 → 2028-06). U15 athletes continue T293 Junior; U17 athletes transition to T293 Plus · Identify 2 athletes for iQFOiL foiling introduction (LA 2028 class pathway) · Target: Asian Ch. podium (Top-3); Worlds: best athlete $\leq$ Top 30% of fleet, 2+ athletes $\leq$ Top 25% · Same annual competition calendar: Asian + European + World Championships · Establish strength/endurance testing battery (ISAF sports science protocols) · Monthly training camps at venues with varied wind conditions · Second coach upgrade to IWA Level 2 certification

Year 3 — Elite Pathway & Olympic Feeder (2028-07 → 2029-06). Top 2 athletes enter iQFOiL Youth program (LA 2028 legacy class) · Target: Asian Ch. Gold in at least one class; Worlds: best athlete $\leq$ Top 20%, 4+ athletes $\leq$ Top 25% of fleet · Full-time coach + sports scientist + physiotherapist support · Same annual competition calendar (Asian + European + World Championships) + Europe-based training block between European and World Championships · Formal talent ID pipeline feeding from State associations to national squad

Year 4-5 — LA 2028 Legacy → Brisbane 2032 (2029-07 → 2031-06). Transition best athletes to Senior iQFOiL squad · Target: Brisbane 2032 Olympic qualification; senior athletes continue the Asian + European + World Championships annual calendar · Replicate T293 pipeline with next generation (current U11s), feeding them into the same 3-championship annual calendar from U13

level · Establish National Sailing Academy with permanent residential coaching · India hosts at least 1 international regatta/year to build racing culture

CLOSING STATEMENT

The 2026 Foça World Championship was the first full Techno 293 world campaign for this Team India squad in its current form. No medals were won, but the regatta produced an unprecedented volume of structured performance data, a clear and evidence-based picture of the team's strengths and weaknesses, and a specific, costed forward plan. The recommendations in Section 4 are the highest-leverage actions the Yachting Association of India can invest in for the next cycle.

Respectfully submitted,

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